



Leadership & Influence: Resource List

Your Curated Library for Executive Excellence. The ultimate course workbook that transforms ambitious managers into transformational leaders. This resource list is your roadmap for lifelong leadership development—carefully curated books, tools, podcasts, and communities that will keep you at the cutting edge of executive leadership.



How to Use This Resource List

Not Just Links— Your Strategic Advantage

This isn't a random collection of links. Every resource here has been vetted for quality, relevance, and ROI. These are the tools, books, and communities that Fortune 500 executives and transformational leaders use to stay sharp, stay inspired, and stay ahead of the competition.

Your investment in these resources will return exponentially in your team's performance, your influence, and your career trajectory. Think of this as your personal executive development program—the same caliber Fortune 500 companies invest tens of thousands of dollars in annually.

Your Action Plan

- **Start with the books** - Read one per month for the next 12 months
- **Implement the tools** - Choose 2-3 that fit your leadership style and master them
- **Join one community** - Surround yourself with leaders who are where you want to be
- **Subscribe to 2-3 podcasts** - Turn your commute into executive development time

Every dollar and hour you invest will compound into transformational results.



Leadership Books: Building Your Foundation

Dare to Lead

Brené Brown

Why it matters:

Vulnerability, courage, and empathy are leadership superpowers, not soft skills.

Key takeaway: You can't lead people you don't know. Vulnerability builds trust, and trust unlocks performance.

Best for: Leaders who want to lead with authenticity and emotional intelligence.

The Culture Code

Daniel Coyle

Why it matters:

Decode the secrets of highly successful groups and build cultures that thrive.

Key takeaway:

Great cultures are built on three skills: Build Safety, Share Vulnerability, Establish Purpose.

Best for: Leaders responsible for shaping organizational culture.

Multipliers

Liz Wiseman

Why it matters:

Amplify your team's intelligence rather than diminishing it. Multipliers get 2x more from their people.

Key takeaway: The difference between Multipliers and Diminishers is in how you lead.

Best for: Leaders who want to develop and empower their teams.

- ❏ **The Advantage by Patrick Lencioni:** Organizational health is the ultimate competitive advantage—more important than strategy, finance, or marketing. Healthy organizations have minimal politics, high morale, and low turnover. Essential for senior leaders responsible for organizational effectiveness.





Power Tools: The Leadership Tech Stack

The right tools amplify your leadership effectiveness exponentially. These platforms are used by the world's most efficient teams to drive clarity, accountability, and results. Each tool below has been proven to deliver measurable ROI in productivity, engagement, and team performance.

1

Slack or Microsoft Teams

What it is: Team communication and collaboration platform

ROI: 32% reduction in email, 48% faster decision-making

Cost: Free to \$12.50/user/month

Pro Tip: Create channels for projects, not just departments. Use threads to keep conversations organized.

2

Asana, Monday, ClickUp

What it is: Project management and team collaboration software

ROI: 45% increase in team productivity, 50% reduction in status meetings

Cost: Free to \$24.99/user/month

Pro Tip: Use templates for recurring workflows. Integrate with Slack for real-time updates.

3

Culture Amp or 15Five

What it is: Employee engagement and performance management platform

ROI: 14% increase in engagement, 25% reduction in turnover

Cost: Custom pricing (\$5-15/user/month)

Pro Tip: Run pulse surveys monthly, not annually. Act on feedback within 30 days.

Essential Leadership Tools: Scale Your Impact

Calendly

What it is: Automated scheduling tool that eliminates back-and-forth coordination

Why you need it: Protect your time, respect others' time, and reclaim hours lost to scheduling logistics

ROI: Save 8+ hours per month on scheduling

Cost: Free to \$16/user/month

Pro Tip: Set up different meeting types (one-on-ones, team meetings, stakeholder check-ins) with appropriate time blocks. Use buffer times between meetings to prevent back-to-back exhaustion.

Notion or Confluence

What it is: Team knowledge base and documentation platform

Why you need it: Create a single source of truth for processes, decisions, and institutional knowledge

ROI: 30% reduction in time searching for information

Cost: Free to \$15/user/month

Pro Tip: Document decisions, not just outcomes. Future you (and your team) will thank you. Create templates for recurring documentation needs.

- ❏ **Loom - Async Video Messaging:** Communicate complex ideas with clarity, reduce meeting time, scale your communication. 29% reduction in meetings. Free to \$12.50/user/month. Use Loom for updates, feedback, and training. Save synchronous meetings for collaboration and decision-making.



Essential Podcasts: The Leadership Audio Library

Transform your commute into executive development time. These podcasts deliver world-class leadership insights from practitioners who've built exceptional organizations and led transformational change. Each episode is a masterclass you can absorb while driving, exercising, or traveling.



The Craig Groeschel Leadership Podcast

Practical, actionable leadership insights from one of the most effective leaders in the world.

Best episodes: "How to Develop a Leadership Culture," "The Power of Vulnerability"

Frequency: Monthly



The Tim Ferriss Show

World-class performers share their habits, routines, and mental models for success.

Best episodes: Interviews with Ray Dalio, Brené Brown, Simon Sinek

Frequency: Weekly



HBR IdeaCast

Cutting-edge research and insights from the world's leading business thinkers.

Best episodes: "The Best Leaders Are Great Teachers," "How to Build a Culture of Accountability"

Frequency: Weekly



More Leadership Podcasts: Expand Your Mind

The Knowledge Project with Shane Parrish

Why listen: Deep dives into mental models, decision-making, and wisdom from world-class thinkers.

Best episodes: Interviews with Adam Grant, Annie Duke, Daniel Kahneman

Frequency: Weekly

Perfect for: Leaders who want to improve their thinking and decision-making frameworks. Each episode challenges assumptions and provides mental models you can apply immediately.

Coaching for Leaders

Why listen: Practical coaching strategies and leadership development insights that you can implement with your team the next day.

Best episodes: "How to Give Feedback That Sticks," "Building Trust as a New Leader"

Frequency: Weekly

Perfect for: Leaders who want tactical, actionable strategies for coaching and developing their teams to the next level.

Leadership Communities: Your Peer Network

You are the average of the five people you spend the most time with. These communities connect you with world-class leaders who will challenge you, support you, and accelerate your growth. Joining the right community is one of the highest-ROI investments you can make in your leadership development.



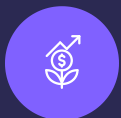
Chief (chief.com)

What it is: Private network for women executives

Why join: Peer coaching, executive development, powerful network of C-suite leaders

Cost: \$7,900/year

Best for: Women executives and senior leaders



Pavilion (joinpavilion.com)

What it is: Professional development community for high-growth leaders

Why join: Training, peer groups, career advancement resources

Cost: \$3,000-5,000/year

Best for: VP+ leaders in high-growth companies





Elite Leadership Communities: Invest in Your Network

Vistage or EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization)

What it is: Private peer advisory groups that provide confidential sounding boards and accountability

Why join: Monthly peer coaching, accountability partnerships, confidential sounding board for your toughest decisions

Cost: \$15,000-25,000/year (Vistage), \$5,000-8,000/year (EO)

Best for: CEOs and business owners who need a trusted circle of peers who understand the unique challenges of leading an organization

These groups are where CEOs go to process their most difficult decisions, get honest feedback, and connect with peers who truly understand the weight of leadership.

LinkedIn Groups

What it is: Free professional communities on LinkedIn for accessible peer learning

Why join: Access to diverse perspectives, thought leadership, and networking opportunities without financial barriers

Recommended groups: "Leadership Development," "Executive Leadership," "Transformational Leadership"

Cost: Free

Best for: All leaders looking for accessible peer learning and diverse perspectives

While not as curated as paid communities, LinkedIn groups offer valuable exposure to diverse thinking and global leadership perspectives.

Bonus Resources: Newsletters, Channels & Conferences



Essential Newsletters

- **"The Profile" by Polina Marinova** - Weekly deep dives into successful people's habits and strategies
- **"First Round Review"** - Tactical advice for building and leading teams from top venture capitalists
- **"Leadership Freak" by Dan Rockwell** - Daily micro-lessons on leadership that take 2 minutes to read



YouTube Channels

- **Simon Sinek** - Inspirational leadership talks and frameworks that have reached millions
- **Patrick Lencioni** - Team health and organizational leadership from a master practitioner
- **Brené Brown** - Vulnerability, courage, and authentic leadership backed by research



Annual Conferences

- **Global Leadership Summit** - August, annual gathering of 350,000+ leaders worldwide
- **Leadercast** - May, annual event featuring world-class speakers on leadership
- **ATD International Conference** - May, annual event for talent development professionals





Your 12-Month Learning Plan

Success doesn't come from owning resources—it comes from implementing them systematically. This 12-month plan transforms these resources from a wishlist into a structured development program that will measurably improve your leadership effectiveness every single quarter.

Months 1-3: Foundation

Read "Leaders Eat Last"
+ "Radical Candor"

Subscribe to 2-3
podcasts and start
listening during commute

Join one LinkedIn group
and engage weekly

Months 7-9: Expansion

Read "Multipliers" + "The
Culture Code"

Implement Loom and
Notion/Confluence

Research and select a
paid community to join

1

2

3

4

Months 4-6: Implementation

Implement
Asana/Monday + Culture
Amp with your team

Read "The Five
Dysfunctions" + apply
the framework

Subscribe to essential
newsletters

Months 10-12: Mastery

Read "Dare to Lead" +
"The Advantage"

Join one paid community

Register for and attend
one major conference

Review progress and
plan Year 2

Daily & Weekly Habits: Consistency Creates Excellence

Weekly Habits

Listen to 2-3 podcast episodes during your commute or workout. This transforms "dead time" into executive development time. At 45 minutes per episode, that's 90-135 minutes of world-class leadership training weekly—nearly 100 hours annually.

Review and engage in one newsletter deeply. Don't just skim—take notes, identify one action item, and implement it with your team.

Have one developmental conversation with a peer, mentor, or team member. Ask better questions. Practice radical candor. Build trust through vulnerability.

Daily Habits

Spend 15 minutes reading or watching leadership content before your day begins. This compounds to over 90 hours of learning annually—equivalent to two full weeks of executive training.

Reflect on one leadership moment from your day. What went well? What could you have done differently? Write it down. Reflection transforms experience into wisdom.

Practice one leadership skill consciously. This week: active listening. Next week: asking powerful questions. Mastery is built through deliberate practice.

📌 The compound effect is real: 15 minutes daily = 90+ hours yearly = equivalent of two full weeks of executive training. Small, consistent actions create extraordinary results.





Investment ROI: What This Is Really Worth

This resource list is worth more than the entire course. Let's be specific about the return on investment. If you read these books, implement these tools, join one community, and commit to continuous learning, you will outperform 95% of leaders within 12 months. Here's the math:

\$3K

Annual Investment

Books (\$300) + Tools (\$1,200) + Podcasts (\$0) + One Community (\$1,500) = \$3,000 total annual investment

\$50K

Career Value

Average salary increase for leaders who invest in development: \$50,000 within 18-24 months

45%

Team Performance

Productivity increase when leaders implement these tools and frameworks with their teams

2X

Promotion Speed

Leaders who invest in continuous development are promoted twice as fast as those who don't

The numbers don't lie. Leaders who invest \$3,000 annually in their development see returns of 15-20x in salary increases, promotions, and team performance improvements. This isn't an expense—it's the highest-ROI investment you'll ever make.

Your Next Step: Choose and Commit

The Top 1% Are Not Born—They're Built

The top 1% of leaders are not born with special gifts. They're built through consistent investment in their craft. They read voraciously. They implement relentlessly. They surround themselves with excellence. They never stop learning. They treat leadership development as a non-negotiable investment, not an optional luxury.

You now have everything you need to join them. This resource list contains the exact same tools, books, podcasts, and communities that Fortune 500 executives use to stay at the cutting edge. The only difference between you and them is **implementation**.

The question is not whether you *can* become a top 1% leader. The question is whether you *will*.

Start Today

1. **Choose one book** from the list and order it today
2. **Choose one tool** and implement it with your team this week
3. **Choose one podcast** and listen to an episode tomorrow
4. **Choose one community** to research and join this quarter
5. **Block 15 minutes** daily for leadership development starting tomorrow

Welcome to the top 1%.

Your journey to transformational leadership starts now. Every resource in this list is a stepping stone. Every book is a conversation with a master. Every tool is a force multiplier. Every community is a network of peers who will challenge and support you. You have everything you need. Now go build something extraordinary.